

Adobe Photoshop CS

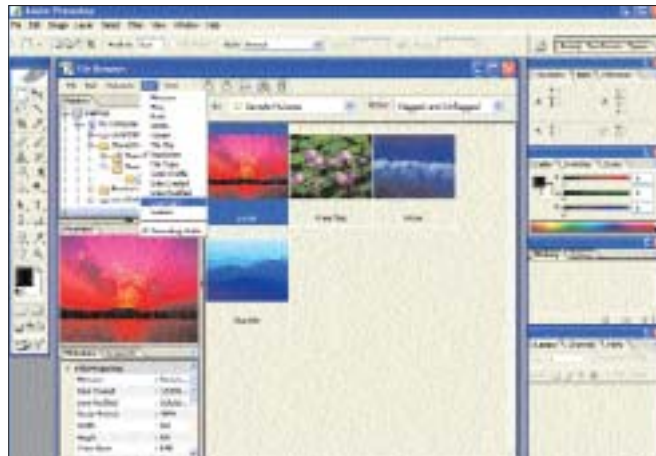
Worth the upgrade

Adobe's Photoshop, considered the *de-facto* image editing software in the market, is now equipped with a set of features that makes it even more productive.

"One of the most useful additions to this latest version is the Filter Gallery. This allows the user to preview all the built-in filters in a new window, and apply multiple filters in one go. I have used this feature and found it quite useful and time-saving", says G V Sreekumar, Assistant Professor at the Industrial Design Centre, Indian Institute of Technology, Mumbai. The filter gallery is useful for beginners not familiar with each filter in Photoshop. Instead of trying out each filter and then pressing undo, one can see the effect of each filter clearly in the gallery.

A floating palette shows histogram information. During colour correction, the histogram palette shows the existing levels and new levels superimposed on each other. This gives a good idea about the extent of correction being applied by the user.

The file browser is improved, and the image preview quality is better. The



The file browser image previews are much better than the earlier versions

interface of the file browser is also improved—it's getting closer and closer to that of image utilities such as ACD-See. It allows you not only to preview, tag and sort images, but also to edit and search with keywords and metadata. Even the History log can be saved as metadata. You can protect your work by adding copyright information directly in the file metadata. Another addition is the ability to share batches of files right from the file browser. A new tool called the Color Replacement brush is a combination of a brush with the

colour option, instead of normal or dissolve. This tool allows you to change the colour of any area of the image while retaining the



The filter gallery shows previews of different effects that can be applied

original texture and shading.

Under the Adjust menu, one can correct the shadow and highlight areas of an image, a time-saving feature useful for photographers and pre-press professionals.

PhotoShop CS allows you to manipulate text, and it still keeps the text editable. For example, you can wrap text around a path, apply distortions and edit text afterwards.

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This is a welcome addition to designers who use text extensively in Photoshop. "I had been waiting for this a long time", says Pratik Shah, a digital imaging professional.

Every designer uses layers in Photoshop. Now you can group layers into nested layer setups, which can contain up to five layers.

Inbuilt scripting allows you to save multiple layers to individual files. Live monitoring of the histogram allows digital imaging artists can now view a live display of composite, as well as individual channels, simultaneously.

Others frills are the Photomerge feature, the Lens Blur effect that actually simulates real-world visual blurring phenomena, the capability to auto-

matically crop multiple scanned images into individual documents, and a preset document size for designing videos or DVDs.

However, "Photoshop's image distortion is still not as good as Adobe Illustrator, where you can edit an image by adding and stretching nodes", feels Ram, an illustrator with the *Times of India*.

Overall, there are a sizeable number of enhancements, which do justify the upgrade.

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

Pentium III or 4, Windows 2000 with SP 3 or Windows XP, 192 MB of RAM, 280 MB hard disk space, 1024 x 768 or greater monitor resolution



Use more two or more images from the Photomerge menu to create a panorama

Adobe Photoshop CS A-	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★